2.5 How to spot unsuitable content

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to spot unsuitable content and behaviour when using the web
- what to do if something upsets you or is confusing.

The good and bad sides of the web

You can use the web to find information and facts to help you with homework and projects. The web is also a place where you can have fun talking to friends and sharing news. You can watch films, listen to music and play games.

However, the web has a bad side too. Some of the information you find will be misleading or incorrect. You cannot trust everything you see on the web.

Be alert, act responsibly and ask for help when you need it. If you are careful, then you can enjoy learning on the web.

How to check content

Is it true?

You should ask this question every time you use the web.

Sometimes, people get facts wrong by mistake. Sometimes, people deliberately try to mislead you. Here are a few checks you can carry out to make sure your content is good quality.

- **Can you check the facts?** Check the information you find on a website against other websites before you use it.
- **When was the information written?** Check that your information is up to date.
- **Is the information on a site you trust?** As you bookmark websites, you will start to build a library of sites you have used many times and that you trust.
- **Is it fact or opinion?** Are opinions backed up by facts?



Does it upset you?

If something on the web upsets you or seems confusing:

- close the page and do not look at it again
- do not show or send it to anyone else
- tell an adult you trust, for example a parent, family member or teacher.

Reporting something that upsets you can be difficult, but it is important that you do. It can save others from being upset in the future. It can help you deal with the problem. It is not your fault.



Activity

Find a web page from the endangered animals activity in the last lesson. When was the information written?



Extra challenge

Revisit a website you have used in this unit. Use the 'Is it true?' questions to check its content. Then write a short report about your findings.

Think again

Search engines designed for young people show fewer adverts and control the content they show you.

Search for 'child-friendly search engine'. Then explore two of the search engines from the first page of results.

2.6 Be sure, be safe

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to stay safe when talking to people online
- how to report problems you experience when using the internet.

Staying safe

- **Chatting** Do not chat with strangers online. It is safer to chat to people you know well. It is safest if you chat to people you know in real life. Don't accept friend requests from strangers. If you feel uncomfortable about someone who sends you a message, you can block them.
- **Sharing** Do not share your personal information or photographs with strangers. Never share your address or phone number with strangers.
- **Opening files** Do not open pictures or other files from people you don't know. If you receive something by email from someone you don't know, do not open it. If you are in doubt, ask an adult you trust for help.
- **Settings** Social media and games sites allow you to set **privacy levels**. Privacy levels let you decide who can see what you share online. If you are unsure how to use privacy settings, ask a family member or teacher to help you. Check your friends list. Make sure you haven't added strangers by accident.

Be kind and respectful

The way you behave online is important. Be kind and respectful in the way you talk to people. Chat online in the same way you would chat at home or in the classroom.

If someone you know is upset or frightened by something they have seen online, offer them help. Advise them to talk to a **trusted adult**.

If you see a friend acting irresponsibly online, share your knowledge of how to stay safe with them.

Reporting problems

If something scares or upsets you online, tell an adult. You will feel better once the problem is in the open. Remember, you are not to blame, and people want to help.

- Tell a family member you trust and can talk to.
- Talk to a teacher you trust. Your school may have a teacher responsible for dealing with online abuse and bullying.

Write down what happened so you can remember the details when you talk to a trusted adult.





Activity

Read your school's advice on using the internet. Make sure you know what your responsibilities are. Make sure you know how to report a problem.



Extra challenge

Make a list of three things your school policy says you should not do when using computers.

Make a list of three things you should do when using computers in school.

Think again

How would you act if something you saw or read on the internet upset or frightened you? Think about who your trusted adults are. Who would you talk to at school and at home if you needed to?

Do you need to ask for help to manage your privacy settings? Make an action list.